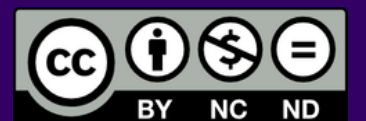


**TELL ME WHAT
THE WATERMARK
DOES AND
I'LL TELL YOU
WHAT YOU THINK
AN LLM IS.**

**How Claude's watermark actually
works, in 9 slides**



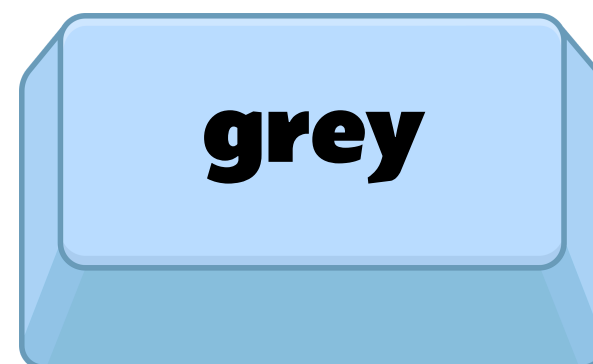
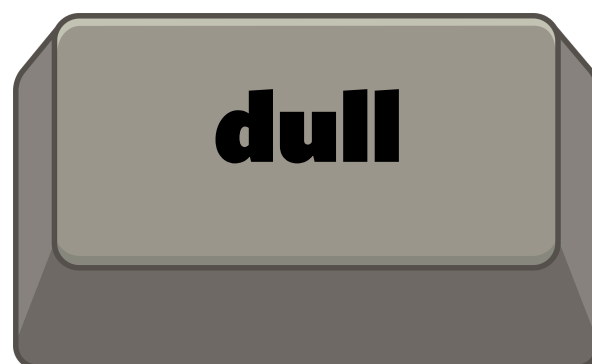
alt-counsel.com



HOW A MODEL PICKS A WORD

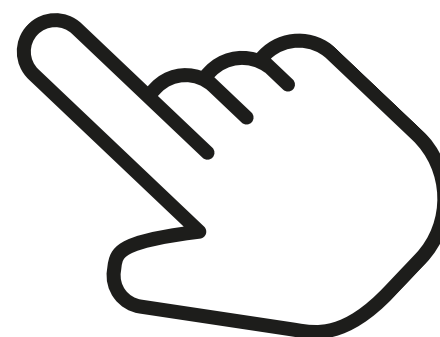
The weather today is cold and

_____.



All three are fine.

The model rolls a die.



WHAT WATERMARKING CHANGED

It loads the die.

The words don't change. The one that gets picked is steered by a hidden key.

Do that a thousand times and the picks form a pattern.

THE MARK NEEDS CHOICES TO HIDE IN

Strong

A client email. A covering letter. An argument. Free prose.

The model had room to move.

Weak

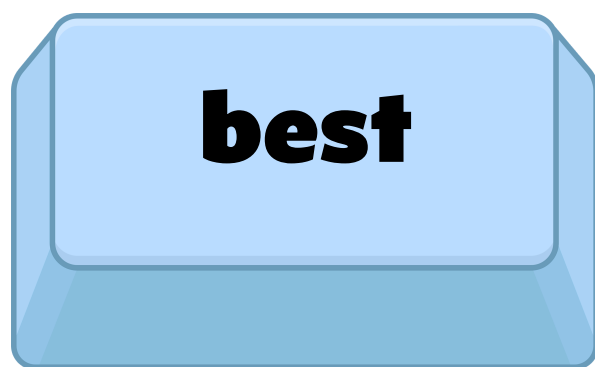
A quoted statute. A defined term. Boilerplate. Code

The model had one right answer.

More freedom, stronger mark.

SAME PICTURE, INSIDE A CONTRACT

**The Contractor shall use its
_____endeavours.**



**It might look the same to the
model.**

Does it look the same to you?

**“EQUALLY GOOD” MEANS “EQUALLY
GOOD” TO THE MODEL**

condition ≠ warranty

guarantee ≠ indemnity

terminate ≠ rescind

The model ranks probability.

The lawyer makes a judgement.

WHAT THE WATERMARK CAN'T DO

It can't name you.

It can't prove who wrote something.

It can't work on a short passage.

No detector has been released as yet.

IN THE POST



Your engagement letter bans AI.
Are you in breach?



Anthropic's two pages describe
two different features.



Why 46% of this blog's commits
admit Claude helped.

[alt-counsel.com/what the
watermark-does](https://alt-counsel.com/what-the-watermark-does)



alt-counsel.com

